

Lemma. Let  $I$  be a proper ideal of an integral domain  $R$ .

If a non-constant monic polynomial  $P(x) = x^n + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \dots + a_1x + a_0$  satisfies

$$\overline{P(x)} = x^n + (\overline{a_{n-1}} + 1)x^{n-1} + \dots + (\overline{a_1} + 1)x + (\overline{a_0} + 1) \in (R/I)[x]$$

cannot be factored into smaller degree polynomials ( $\Leftrightarrow$  irreducible)

then  $P(x)$  is irreducible in  $R[x]$ .

Proof. Suppose that  $\overline{P(x)}$  cannot be factored, and  $P(x)$  is reducible.

That is,  $P(x) = a(x) \cdot b(x)$  where  $a(x), b(x)$  are non-constant monic polynomials.

Then,  $\overline{a(x)}$  and  $\overline{b(x)}$  is the factor of  $\overline{P}$ , it is contradiction.

Eisenstein Criterion.

Let  $P$  be a prime ideal in the integral domain  $R$ .

Suppose that a non-constant monic polynomial

$$f(x) = x^n + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \dots + a_1x + a_0 \in R[x]$$

satisfies  $a_{n-1}, \dots, a_1, a_0 \in P$  but  $a_0 \notin P^2$ , then  $f$  is irreducible.

Proof. Suppose that  $f(x)$  is reducible, factorizes as  $f(x) = a(x)b(x)$ ,

where  $a(x)$  and  $b(x)$  are monic, degree smaller than  $f(x)$ . Write

$$a(x) = x^r + \alpha_{r-1}x^{r-1} + \dots + \alpha_1x + \alpha_0 \quad \text{and}$$

$$b(x) = x^s + \beta_{s-1}x^{s-1} + \dots + \beta_1x + \beta_0. \quad \text{Then, by the assumption,}$$

$$\overline{f(x)} = x^n + (\overline{a_{n-1}} + 1)x^{n-1} + \dots + (\overline{a_0} + 1) = x^n = \overline{a(x)} \overline{b(x)}.$$

Since  $P$  is prime,  $R/P$  is again the integral domain,

so either  $\overline{\alpha_0}$  or  $\overline{\beta_0}$  is zero. WLOG, let  $\overline{\alpha_0} = 0$ .

Then,  $\overline{\alpha_1} \cdot \overline{\beta_0}$  must be zero, as the unique degree 1 coefficient of  $\overline{f}$ ,

so  $\overline{\alpha_1}$  or  $\overline{\beta_0}$  is zero. If  $\overline{\beta_0}$ , then  $\alpha_0, \beta_0 \in P \Rightarrow \alpha_0\beta_0 \in P^2$ , contradiction

If  $\overline{\alpha_1} = 0$ , then similarly,  $\overline{\beta_0} = 0$  or  $\overline{\alpha_2} = 0$ . Inductively, if  $\overline{\alpha_{r-1}} = \dots = \overline{\alpha_1} = \overline{\alpha_0} = 0$ ,

then  $1 \cdot \overline{\beta_0} = 0$ , so,  $\overline{\beta_0} = 0$ , or  $\beta_0 \in P$ . Now,  $\alpha_0\beta_0 \in P^2$ , thus proved.